THE NON-SALESY DM FIELD KIT

Worksheets beside the inbox.

Printable worksheets for The Non-Salesy DM

MM

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FIELD KIT · BEFORE THE INBOX

WORKSHEET 1: THE FIVE-SENTENCE OFFER BRIEF

Complete once per offer. Revise it after every ten real conversations (Chapter 0).

Sentence	Job	Your version
Buyer	Who, in what buying situation	
Problem	An observable difficulty, in buyer language	
Change	What your work is meant to improve	
Delivery	What you actually build or deliver	
Boundary	When it's not the right fit	
Price	Fee or range, currency, one-time or recurring	
Proof	Evidence you can show, with its period and your contribution	
What I can't promise	Outcomes that depend on the buyer or the market	

Explain-it-back test: a peer's version of my offer: _____

WORKSHEET 2: FIVE-MINUTE RESEARCH CARDS

Field	Prospect 1	Prospect 2
Name, role, company		
Source + date I actually reviewed		
Exact observation		
Possible implication (tentative)		
Why my work might be relevant		
One question that could disprove it		
Fit: clear / possible / absent		
Context: explicit / relevant / weak		
Access: relationship / intro / new		
Prior contact, permission or stop condition		

"I chose this person because..." 1: _____ 2: _____

WORKSHEET 3: THE SEND CHECK + PAUSE TEST

Before any message:

☐ Correct person, current role.

☐ The observation is accurate and actually relevant.

☐ No unsupported claim about their problem or results.

☐ My reason for speaking is clear and commercially honest.

☐ One primary trust job, one main question or request.

☐ Unnecessary praise, jargon and padding removed.

☐ Any link is relevant, working and genuinely included.

☐ The relationship supports this message; no stop instruction.

☐ **Screenshot Test:** I'd be comfortable if they posted this publicly.

The Pause Test: Am I sending this because it helps the buyer, or because I'm uncomfortable with the silence?

☐ Not trying to rush a gate

☐ Not relieving my own uncertainty

☐ Not adding "value" out of fear they won't respond

☐ Not asking for a call because I don't know what else to say

☐ Following the buyer's signal, not my sequence

☐ Not answering an objection they haven't raised

☐ Not creating urgency that doesn't exist

If a factual or permission check fails, don't send. Better wording doesn't fix a false premise. And if they asked you a direct question, answer it.

WORKSHEET 4: THE DAILY OS CARD

Scan → **Sort** → **Diagnose** → **Choose** → **Move** → **Record** → **Rehydrate** · 30–45 min · never a sending quota

Date	My promises due	Replies needing judgment	Moves made (incl. pauses)	Records updated	Rehydrations (with trigger)

TRUST Loop, per thread: **T**rack the state · **R**ecognize the gate · **U**nderstand the risk · **S**ignal the missing belief · **T**ake one step

APPENDIX A: THE TRUST DEBUGGER

Use the full Debugger on significant, stalled or confusing threads. For routine exchanges, the short version is enough: **evidence → open question → move → stop condition.** Never delay a straightforward answer to fill in a worksheet.

Thread / date: _____ Exact last buyer signal: _____

#	Question	Answer
1	What does the buyer believe right now? (evidence, not mind-reading)	
2	What don't they believe or understand yet?	
3	What are they protecting? (time, money, reputation, capacity…)	
4	Which gate is open? (write the question, not just the number)	
5	What's their likely posture, and one alternative reading?	
6	P(outcome): strong / weak / unknown, and why	
7	What value is relevant, in their words?	
8	What perceived risk or hard constraint is present?	
9	Last trust deposit?	
10	Last trust withdrawal?	
11	What signal is missing?	
12	Smallest appropriate move (including pause, decline, stop)?	
13	**What should I NOT do?**	

The Pause Test: Am I sending this because it helps the buyer, or because I'm uncomfortable with the silence?

What response would change my diagnosis? _____

> **Completed example.** A buyer says the service looks useful but asks whether their team must attend weekly sessions. Earlier, they mentioned a major launch. *Evidence supports:* interest plus a concern about participation. *Does not establish:* fear of investing, or a price objection. *Gate:* G4 (what does this require of us?). *TU:* Value strong; P(outcome) unknown; Risk weak (capacity). *Missing signal:* an honest participation schedule. *Move:* Clarifier, then a timing decision if needed. *Do NOT:* send another testimonial or promise it'll be effortless.

APPENDIX B: SIX GATE REFERENCE SHEET

Gate	Buyer's question	Signals	Increases trust	Decreases trust	First moves
G1 Reality	Is this person real and coherent?	"Do we know each other?" Profile check	Accurate identity, truthful context, coherent profile	Fake familiarity, vague affiliation, profile contradiction	Clarifier, Self-Disclosure
G2 Relevance	Does this matter to me?	"Why are you asking?" "Not my area"	Specific observation; a question that can be answered "no"	Diagnosing from a job title	Clarifier, Insight Gift
G3 Fit	Do they understand my situation?	Corrections, "we're different"	Accurate recap, meaningful distinction	Forcing a standard diagnosis	Mirror, Clarifier
G4 Safety	Is it safe to explore?	"What would you need from us?"	Clear time, inputs, boundaries, exit	Surprise commitments, reassurance adjectives	Clarifier
G5 Value	Is it worth the total investment?	Price, alternatives, "why not DIY?"	Real proof, clear scope, honest alternatives	Inflated ROI, hidden price	Story, Clarifier
G6 Identity	Is this the right decision for us?	Approvals, ownership, final reservations	Precise recap, explicit responsibilities, space	Identity pressure, bypassing approvers	Mirror, Clarifier

Remember: gates can be passed before the DM (via content and profile) and can reopen (gate regression). Use the earliest open gate that blocks the next step. One primary trust job per touch, while answering every material question honestly.

APPENDIX C: TRUST UTILITY WORKSHEET

Trust Utility = P(outcome) × Value − Perceived Risk. A qualitative diagnostic. Never compute a number.

Term	Rating (strong / weak / unknown)	Evidence from this conversation	What's still unknown?
P(outcome): can it work *for them*?			Capability, mechanism, fit or implementation?
Value: does it matter to them, now?			Compared with what?
Perceived risk: what might they lose or have to put in?			Information gap, or a real constraint?

Likely bottleneck: ____

A question that would test it: ____

A proportionate signal or scope change: ____

An alternative that may serve them better: ____

What would justify pausing or declining? ____

Calculation discipline: if the buyer gives you numbers, record the source and assumptions and calculate only what the inputs support. Five unsuitable 30-minute calls = 2.5 hours in calls, not 2.5 hours of recoverable profit. Keep capacity freed, potential revenue, signed value and cash collected separate.

APPENDIX D: FIVE TRUST MOVES MATRIX

Move	Purpose	Use when	Best gates	Misuse to catch
Mirror	Make understanding visible and correctable	Hesitation, feeling misunderstood, resistance	G3, G6	Invented emotion; mechanical repetition; "...which is why you need us"
Clarifier	Reduce a specific ambiguity	Process, terms, scope or next step unclear	G1, G2, G4, G5	Lectures; jargon; limits buried at the end
Insight Gift	A useful, bounded way to see the issue	Curiosity; control resistance; they need evidence of thinking	G2, G3	Baited gifts; implied debt; speculative full audits
Story	Ground a mechanism or trade-off	They can't picture how it works	G5	Fabricated proof; irrelevant success stories
Self-Disclosure	State a relevant truth or limit	Skepticism from polished language	G1, G3	Manufactured vulnerability; asking for sympathy

Missing signal: _ *Chosen move:* _ Why it fits this gate: _ *How I'll recognize a misunderstanding:* _

APPENDIX E: SIGNAL RECOGNITION CHEAT SHEET

Three different classifications. Don't mix them up. State = how they're engaging (Ch 4). **Gate** = what they're deciding (Ch 5). **Rung** = what they're doing (Ch 10).

Signal	Plausible state	Likely gate	Ladder rung	Check before advancing
Like / view	Unknown	—	Attention	Nothing is established
"Thanks!"	Courtesy	G1–G2	Attention	Was any business issue raised?
"Interesting."	Curious / polite	G2	Curiosity	Two-Hypothesis Reply
Questions about the method	Curious / exploring	G2–G3	Interest	General, or about *their* situation?
Detailed context, unprompted	Exploring	G3	Exploration	Does it show a problem your work fits?
Questions about proof	Skeptical / evaluating	G3–G5	Exploration	Which claim or similarity is in doubt?
Questions about workload or process	Hesitant / planning	G4	Intent	Is capacity available, or just unclear?
Questions about price, terms, start	Evaluating / ready	G5–G6	Intent → Readiness	Who decides? What's still open?
"I need to think about it."	Hesitant	Any	Varies	Which TU term? One gentle clarification
Silence	Several possible	—	—	What was agreed? Is another contact justified?
Clear refusal	A boundary	—	—	**Stop.** It's not a hidden buying signal

Confidence labels: directly stated · strongly suggested · plausible · unknown.

APPENDIX F: CONVERSATION POST-MORTEM

Before: what did I think the buyer needed?
Reality: what did they actually signal?
Gate: which question was open?
Emotion: what posture did I infer, and what else was possible?
Trust: did my moves create or reduce safety?
Risk: what risk did I increase or decrease?
Signal: what did I establish?
Mistake: where did I move too quickly?
Next: what will I do differently?

One supported lesson: ____ One change to test: ____

Review wins as carefully as losses. Avoid hindsight stories ("they were never serious") without evidence. Record loss reasons in the buyer's words; if unknown, write "unknown."

APPENDIX G: CONVERSATION REHYDRATION MAP

Check	If yes	If no
Did they ask not to be contacted?	Stop. Keep the boundary.	Keep checking. No refusal isn't permission.
Did they invite a revisit (date or milestone)?	Return when it's met.	Look for material new context; elapsed time is weak.
Is the new context genuinely connected?	Name it briefly.	Don't invent a reason.
Can the message be low-effort and easy to decline?	Small status question or relevant update.	Shrink the ask, or don't send.
Do they decline or leave no next step?	Close the record.	Record the new agreement.

Draft from memory, not pretense: What we actually discussed: ____ What was agreed about future contact: ____ Why a return is relevant now: ____ Smallest useful question: ____ Stopping point after this: ____

Five qualities of a good rehydration: contextual · low-pressure · relevant · easy to ignore · consistent in tone.

APPENDIX H: MODALITY READINESS CHECKLIST

☐ I can say which question this format resolves better than text.

☐ The buyer asked for or agreed to the format.

☐ Length and preparation are proportionate.

☐ A written alternative exists where needed.

☐ Nothing sensitive is on screen or in the recording.

☐ Any recording is agreed before it starts.

☐ For calls: purpose, participants, time zone and output are clear.

☐ Material promises will be confirmed in writing.

☐ Declining the format won't become a reason to pressure them.

Coherence Check before any escalation: Profile ✓ · Content ✓ · Conversation tone ✓ · Offer follows the problem ✓ · Format fits trust level ✓ · Promise believable ✓

Text → voice → video → call is not a mandatory ladder. Use the lowest-friction format that supports an accurate decision.

APPENDIX I: 30-DAY SPRINT TRACKER

Days	Focus	Done / evidence
0	Baseline: substantive replies, volunteered context, open promises, dead-end records	
1–3	Baseline, fact vs. inference, Trust Graph Audit	
4–7	States, gates, Trust Utility, weekly review	
8–10	Promises, stop conditions, profile	
11–14	Offer clarity, trust tax, honest correction, coherence	
15–17	Mirror, Clarifier, Insight Gift	
18–21	Story, Self-Disclosure, one trust job, TRUST Loop	
22–24	Content bridge, modality, offer transition	
25–28	Objections, rehydration, proposal, delivery handoff	
29–30	Post-mortems and next cycle	

Daily reflection: What I observed · What I first assumed · What I did (including a justified pause) · What changed / stayed unknown · Metric · Tomorrow's adjustment.

APPENDIX J: DAILY LINKEDIN DM OPERATING SYSTEM

Scan → Sort → Diagnose → Choose → Move → Record → Rehydrate

Priority: my promises → meaningful replies → justified follow-ups → rehydration → new outreach.
Time box: 30–45 minutes. Never a sending quota.

Step	Question
Scan	What did buyers actually say or do? What did I promise?
Sort	Which state is each thread in? (evaluation · exploring · promised · invited revisit · peer · dormant · inactive · do-not-contact)
Diagnose	Which state, gate and weakest TU term?
Choose	Which signal is missing, and which move supplies it (or pause)?
Move	One primary job, the right format
Record	What changed? Next action or stop condition?
Rehydrate	Is there an invited trigger or genuine new context?

Trust Graph Audit row: Person · Relationship type · Last meaningful exchange + date · What's established · What's open · What I promised · Permitted next action or stop.

Weekly review: unique contacts · unique replies (refusals separate) · substantive conversations · qualified · evaluations · proposals · outcomes · time spent. Counts next to percentages. One change per week.

APPENDIX K: COMMON TRUST-LEAKING BEHAVIORS

Trust leak	Corrective action
Fabricated familiarity	State the real relationship and why you're contacting them
Generic praise before a pitch	Use a relevant observation, or drop the praise
Diagnosing from a public clue	Separate the fact, the hypothesis and the question
Overloaded first message	One reason to talk, one manageable response
"What's your biggest challenge?"	Ask about one observable situation
Treating "thanks" as intent	Distinguish courtesy, interest, problem and evaluation
Interrogation (budget, authority, revenue at once)	Explain why a detail matters; ask in proportion
Free full engagement before fit	Bounded contribution; paid diagnosis for real investigation
Hiding price to protect the meeting	State price, range or pricing drivers
Manufactured urgency or scarcity	Use real timing and real constraints only
Following the sequence, not the conversation	Let the live thread override the plan
Unrequested audit or long video	Ask first; keep it bounded
Surprise meeting, participants or recording	Agree format, purpose and conditions first
Identity pressure ("serious founders invest")	Let the buyer's own criteria decide
Hiding: no clear offer for a ready buyer	Recap → reason → request, with price
Irrelevant or exaggerated proof	Explain the mechanism and the limits of comparability
Sounding unlike yourself ("crushing it," "quick brain-pick")	Read it aloud; say it like a respected professional would
Guilt-based close-outs	Close respectfully, once
Contacting after a no	Stop. Never switch channel or person to get around it
Promises lost in delivery	Transfer scope, dependencies and commitments explicitly

The ethical floor: no faked compliments, manufactured urgency, exploited vulnerability, false scarcity, fabricated proof, implied endorsements or fake personalization. Trust is not a technique for bypassing consent.

WHAT'S NEXT

Put the system to work

Your Complete Edition includes the **Implementation System**:

- **Trust Graph Tracker:** the dashboard, audit, sprint log and weekly metrics with honest denominators, ready to use.
- **AI Thread Debugger:** paste any DM thread and get a diagnosis using this book's method: state, gate, TU, missing signal, smallest move and what *not* to do.
- **Printable Field Kit:** every worksheet in the appendices, formatted for daily use.

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